



Brand HQ — Foundation Brief

The umbrella you can hang many things on. First tenant: the personal-AI service. Built so ChartQuest — and whatever comes next — fits without a rebrand.

The promise (the parent brand)

PLNLY makes the powerful, fast-moving tools of modern life genuinely usable — set up around how a person actually lives, and handed over so they own it. The audience isn't intimidated by technology; they're time-poor, or they want their kids fluent and safe. The brand should read as competence and restraint, not reassurance or hand-holding.

Signature line — locked (June 19, 2026). Built bespoke. Yours to run. The short, mark-adjacent line: *built bespoke* signals tailored and premium without screaming it (Park Hyatt, tailoring, the well-made object), the *built-bespoke* b-b is the punch, and *yours to run* is the ownership close. Retires "modern life, minus the jargon," which belonged to the superseded audience. Locked treatment: sentence case, periods, no commas — **Built bespoke. Yours to run.** Two clean beats; the lowercase keeps it quiet.

Essence line. *A beautiful plainness* — the brand's private north star, the feeling it is built to give. Used quietly (under the logo, in About copy), not as a selling headline.

Hero headline — open. The blueprint/brain line was scrapped (June 19, 2026). The homepage/about sentence that explains the ownership thesis is deferred to the site-copy stage (Launch Plan, Week 3), where it can be written in context rather than in the abstract.

Who it's for

Two segments, Brooklyn/NYC first, then online.

1. Affluent, time-constrained households. Busy parents, frequent travelers, families who could figure out the AI tools themselves and would rather not spend the hours. They want AI configured around how they actually live — scheduling, groceries, bills, travel, household operations — while staying in control of their own systems. They are buying back time and building capability, not hiring a butler.

2. Parents of college-bound teens. They want their kids to build real, responsible AI tool literacy before campus — using tools like NotebookLM correctly, getting citations right, staying inside academic-integrity lines. This is tool fluency, scoped tightly. It is not subject tutoring.

The shape of the service — fluid, not a four-item menu. The work shows up as setup, teaching, ongoing support, and the college-prep track — but those are anchors, not walls. A household should be able to see its own need in the offer even when that need isn't named on the page. Travel is the clearest example: never the headline, always at home inside the service. The offer describes a capability, and the client should picture their own life inside it.

Positioning — the one thing that makes it ours

Every competitor in this space delegates: they run the AI for the client and keep the keys. PLNLY hands the keys over. We set the systems up, teach the household to run them, and leave them owning the capability — not dependent on us. Ownership, not concierge. That distinction is the brand, and it should be felt in everything from the visual identity to the way the service is sold.

Personality / voice — locked

One line: PLNLY is the capable friend with great taste — treats you as a peer, says it once and says it well, and never raises its voice.

The core, in order — capable, then warm, with edges. PLNLY is the person who happens to be excellent at this and likes you enough to set it up right. It doesn't reassure: reassurance assumes you're worried, and PLNLY assumes you're smart and busy and just don't want to lose the weekend to it. It isn't cold about that competence either — the warmth is the warmth of being treated as an equal, not a hug or a helper hovering at your elbow. The edge — dry, occasional, never mean

— keeps it from sliding into customer-service cheer or luxury-concierge gloss. Neither is us; one talks down, the other performs up.

Restraint is the volume knob, not a separate trait. Capability shown, not announced. Warmth in one well-chosen word, not a friendly paragraph. The edge as a soft aside, not a punchline asking for a laugh. The calm is greige-grounded — not white and airy, not warm-and-fluffy or yellow — sleek and simple: a beautiful plainness, never sparse or clinical. One accent over a palette. The confident thing left unsaid.

Executable contrasts:

- Says "Here's the setup. You've got it from here." Never "Don't worry — it's so easy!"
- One dry aside, rarely. Never a brand-voice "joke" reaching to be relatable.
- One restrained accent on a greige ground. Never a palette doing the talking.
- Names the real tool and the real task. Never "AI-powered solutions."

Naming — locked

Name is **PLNLY** (written/stylized wordmark) with **Plainly** as the spoken name. Domains purchased: plnly.co (primary) and plnly.nyc (defensive) — via Spaceship, \$8.86 total, June 16, 2026. The unstylized "plainly" spelling is parked by third parties at plainly.com and plainly.co — not a live competing business, just resale squatting; not worth pursuing.

Logo treatment: "Plainly" sits under the PLNLY wordmark as a pronunciation hint — a designed reveal, not a fallback. Every new-context surface (site headline, Instagram bio, first line of a pitch) should pair PLNLY with "Plainly" at first contact so the stylization never has to stand alone unexplained.

Diligence log — name clearance

Date: June 16, 2026

Searched by: Billy, directly (not delegated — see note below)

Databases checked:

- USPTO trademark database (federal trademark search) — search terms "PLNLY" and "Plainly"
- New York State Department of State, Division of Corporations entity search — same terms

Result: No conflicting registrations, applications, or existing entities returned under either name in either system, per Billy's direct review.

What this is, and isn't: This is a self-conducted clearance search against two public databases — a reasonable, real first pass, and worth having on record with a date attached. It is not a comprehensive trademark clearance search of the kind a trademark attorney would run (which typically also covers common-law/unregistered use, state trademark registries beyond NY, similar-sounding marks, and design-mark conflicts, not just exact-text matches). Claude attempted to independently verify via USPTO's live search system and was unable to — the official system requires JavaScript rendering that tools here can't execute, and no authoritative API access was available. That attempt produced no usable results and is not represented as a second confirming search.

Before spending money beyond domains and logo work: a short consult with a trademark attorney is still the recommended next gate, per the original brand brief. This diligence log satisfies the first half; the second half is still open.

Visual direction — set (execution → Claude Design)

Defined off Billy's taste references (see About Me). The ground is greige — not white, not cold, but not warm-and-fluffy or yellow either; greige leading, with warm neutrals and soft blues, greens, and greys layered in, and one confident, sparing accent. Sleek and simple — a beautiful plainness; calm, not empty. References: Aesop-level restraint, Park Hyatt / Edition warmth, quality-everyday-object energy (Aer, Bellroy, Shinola). Hard avoids: tech-bro SaaS blue-and-white, gradient mesh, AI clichés (circuit patterns, neural-network line art, robots), startup-generic, and the white airy-minimalist look — the brand is calm, not sparse. The earlier "rounded, friendly, approachable mark" sketch was tied to the old audience and has been removed; the direction is restraint and quiet confidence.

The house (how the spokes ladder up)

- **The core AI service** — in-home/remote setup, teaching, and ongoing support: the first paid offering and near-term earner. (Current sub-page is still titled "AI for Regular Folks" — that name is a remnant of the old framing, flagged for review.)
- **ChartQuest** — proof you can teach plus build-in-public content under the brand.
- **Brooklyn Kin** — stays its own care/companion venture; future bridge is AI-for-accessibility, not a day-one merge.
- **The blog / content engine** — the hub that markets all of it for free.
- **Recovery / poetry project** — kept separate; the quiet emotional credibility behind the person.

Next decisions

1.  Brand strategy session complete → [Creative Brief — Visual Identity \(for Claude Design\)](#). (June 19, 2026).
2. Carry the brief into Claude Design: logo, color, type, the system.
3. Stand up the one-page site + booking + payment (see Launch Plan).

 Core AI Service — Offer & Go-to-Market